Automakers descend on Paris

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【要点】

・パリモーターショーが開幕し、中国の自動車メーカーが大きな影響力を持つようになっている。8月の欧州での自動車販売の8台に1台が中国製で、プラグインハイブリッド車の急増が主な要因である。

・欧州委員会と北京は金曜日にハイブリッド車の流入を抑制する合意を発表したが、具体的な詳細は明らかにされていない。

・フォルクスワーゲンはタリフ導入を求めており、産業促進法の成立と排出ガス規制の柔軟性強化をポリシーメーカーに要請している。

・今年のショーには16社の中国自動車メーカーが出展しており、ファーウェイ傘下のAitoとBYDが共同出資するDenzaを含む2社の高級車メーカーが新たに市場に参入している。

・フォルクスワーゲンはショーのスローガンを「For Europe」とし、欧州製造要件を設定する産業加速化協定を推進する必要性を強調している。

【メール原文】

Presented by BMW Group By MARTINA SAPIO with JORDYN DAHL and TOMMASO LECCA SNEAK PEEK —The Paris Auto Show opens today and the biggest impact will be

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PRESENTED BY

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SNEAK PEEK

—The Paris Auto Show opens today and the biggest impact will be from Chinese carmakers.

— Ireland’s latest EU budget compromise scales back the Connecting Europe Facility from the Commission’s proposal.

— Think tank InfluenceMap and MEP Piotr Müller reacted to IAG boss Luis Gallego’s criticism of EU climate policies in an interview with POLITICO.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

DRIVING THE DAY

CHINESE CARMAKERS FLOOD PARIS AUTO SHOW: Chinese automakers are making a splash at the show — some are known champions like BYD or Changan, while others are subsidiaries or new brands entering the European market. Here's everything you need to know.

Broader picture: Facing sluggish sales and overcapacity at home, Chinese automakers are exporting to new markets. With access to the U.S. blocked, that leaves Europe as the biggest available market. In August, one in eight cars bought in the bloc was Chinese, thanks largely to a boom in sales of plug-in hybrid electric vehicles.

Not so fast: The European Commission and Beijing announced an agreement on Friday to curb the flood of hybrid vehicles. The executive declined to give any specifics about the deal.

More is needed: Volkswagen has repeatedly called on the Commission to slap tariffs on Chinese hybrids. The German automaker welcomed "the recent progress" at its press conference on Sunday afternoon in Paris, but called on policymakers to help the industry by passing the Industrial Accelerator Act and introducing more flexibilities on mandatory emissions targets.

For Europe: VW's motto at the show is "For Europe," a flashing sign referencing the IAA that would set Made in Europe requirements for the sector. The automaker's newest models show "how Europe can win, developed in Europe, produced in Europe for Europe," said CEO Oliver Blume. French Industry Minister Sébastien Martin later took the stage to defend the IAA, a regulation put forward by French Commissioner Stéphane Séjourné.

Chinese carmakers at the show: Sixteen Chinese automakers are at this year's show. Most are targeting mass-market consumers with cheaper, tech-filled models, but there are two luxury carmakers — targeting a segment that has so far faced little competition. One is Aito, an EV brand formed by Chinese telecom giant Huawei and Seres, a state-owned automaker. The other is Denza — a joint venture founded in 2010 by BYD and Mercedes-Benz. The German automaker offloaded its final stake in 2024, and Denza launched its first models in France earlier this year.

China hits its stride: Chinese companies have increased their presence at Europe's auto shows in recent years; Renault was the lone European automaker to attend the final Geneva auto show in 2024 before the show was permanently shuttered.

On the European side: Most European brands are there, although BMW pulled out in July, citing a "shift in priorities."

Timing: The show opens today for press with the general public able to attend starting on Tuesday. It runs until Sunday.

TRANSPORT BUDGET

CEF TAKES A HIT IN EU BUDGET BATTLE: Ireland's latest compromise for the EU's multiyear budget would trim the Connecting Europe Facility to €69.7 billion from the Commission's original proposal of €81.4 billion. Transport and military mobility would get €45.7 billion, including €15.6 billion for military

mobility, while energy would get €24 billion.

Still bigger than today: Even after the cuts, CEF would remain substantially larger than in the current budget, which allocates it €31.6 billion. OF that, transport gets €25.7 billion and military mobility only €1.8 billion.

The political fight: Ireland is trying to bridge two camps: a 17-country coalition dubbed the "Friends of Cohesion" which wants to protect agriculture and regional funding, while Germany, Sweden, Denmark, the Netherlands, Finland and Austria want much deeper spending cuts. Dublin largely shielded cohesion and farm spending, pushing more of the savings onto competitiveness, defense, external action and infrastructure — including CEF.

Dublin's defense: Thomas Byrne, Ireland's European affairs minister who is leading the Council presidency's budget talks, told reporters Saturday that the compromise makes cuts while still preserving newer priorities.

Frugals not buying it: Germany and its allies argued the cuts are still far too small and complain that the compromise protects too much traditional spending while taking more from areas they favor, including competitiveness, defense and connectivity, our colleague Gregorio Sorgi reports. That means the CEF numbers are still very much in play as leaders head into the next round of budget talks, with the European Council meeting on Thursday and Friday.

A message from BMW Group: Ambitious targets cannot create demand on their own. Europe's mobility transition will only succeed if it is attractive, affordable and practical for consumers and businesses. BMW Group's Dr. Frank Niederländer explores what we need to turn ambition into uptake here .

AVIATION

GALLEGO'S CRITICISM OF EU GREEN POLITICIES SPARKS FRESH DEBATE: IAG CEO Luis Gallego's criticism of EU climate policies is generating some strong reactions. In an interview with POLITICO on Thursday, the airline chief warned that policies such extending the EU Emissions Trading System and certain mandates under ReFuelEU Aviation could "destroy aviation in Europe" and help foreign airlines.

Same old song: InfluenceMap, which monitors corporate and industry association lobbying on climate policy, considers Gallego's attacks on these regulations part of the "narratives that the industry has been pushing for almost two decades." The CEO's remarks "are yet another example of this classic playbook , which consists of repeatedly pitting regional efforts to address aviation emissions against global measures," said Béatrice des Boscs, senior aviation analyst at the think tank.

On the substance: InfluenceMap warned that calls to align ETS carbon prices with those under the U.N.'s Carbon Offsetting and Reduction Scheme for International Aviation "would significantly weaken the policy and lower the potential revenue available for climate action," des Boscs told Tommaso. She cited a 2024 report that compared an EU ETS carbon price of €80 per ton with an average CORSIA credit price of €3.20 per ton in 2022.

Fueling fossil dependency: Des Boscs noted that "approximately 99.4% of jet fuel today is fossil-based." Yet airlines are calling for a slower green transition, citing rising energy and fuel costs, "even though these challenges are partly the result of their long-standing opposition to efficient climate policies," she added.

Conservative support: Polish MEP Piotr Müller of the European Conservatives and Reformists, backed Gallego's criticism and accused the Commission of ignoring industry warnings. He said the Commission "continues to act as though its policy assumptions matter more than market realities."

On ETS: The Commission's claim "that extending the ETS will protect competitiveness rings hollow when airline chiefs warn that the cumulative regulatory burden could threaten their financial viability," Müller told Tommaso.

ReFuelEU criticism: "If the required synthetic fuels are unavailable in sufficient quantities, penalties will not fill the supply gap. They will simply add costs that ultimately reach passengers," Müller said, adding that he had recently raised these concerns with the Commission, calling for a "more realistic approach that makes better use of sustainable biofuels."

DO BETTER, ZAVENTEM: EU countries and airports need to "do their job" so travelers aren't stuck in airports for hours over the Christmas holidays, Internal Affairs Commissioner Magnus Brunner told Playbook's Zoya Sheftalovich in an interview. The new Entry/Exit System is "a security issue. It has to work. The member states had enough time to prepare themselves for this system," he said.

Happy anniversary, now wait: A year ago today, member countries began rolling out the EES, which digitally registers the fingerprints and photos of non-EU visitors to the bloc. Since it became fully operational in April , travelers have been plagued by long waits at some airports including at Brussels Zaventem.

"Some member states are a bit behind," Brunner acknowledged. "We have some challenges, like Zaventem for instance, in Belgium, but also in other member states. And they have to do their job. They agreed on the new system, and now it's up to the member states to do their job." The Commission offered support from border agency Frontex and funding to help implement the system, Brunner said, insisting he's "very confident" the issues will be ironed out. Zoya reached out to Zaventem and the Belgian government for comment.

By the numbers: The EES has recorded almost 230 million entries and exits across roughly 1,500 border points, Brunner said, of which about 80,000 people were turned away, including 2,000 who were deemed security threats due to links to terrorism or organized crime. "So you see, it actually works. And it pays off," Brunner said.

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MARITIME

SYRIA DEMANDS PROBE INTO BLACK SEA SHIP ATTACK: Syria is calling on the International Maritime Organization and Bulgarian authorities to investigate the sinking of the Togo-flagged Alfa Watan in the Black Sea — and why search-and-rescue operations were halted while crew members remain missing.

Bigger picture: The Alfa Watan was one of several commercial ships attacked in the Black Sea last week, sharpening concern over the spillover of the Russia-Ukraine war into civilian shipping and adding pressure for clearer protections for merchant vessels and crews in the region.

A message from BMW Group: Europe’s automotive industry is entering a crucial decade. As manufacturers navigate electrification, global competition, geopolitical uncertainty and rising energy costs, Europe faces the challenge of delivering decarbonization while strengthening competitiveness and resilience. In this Q&A , POLITICO Studio speaks to Dr. Frank Niederländer, Vice President for Government Affairs Europe at BMW Group, about the choices and conditions that will shape the next phase of Europe’s automotive transition. He discusses how Europe can strengthen the industrial base behind the transition, what it will take to build a competitive battery ecosystem and why establishing new capabilities requires the right investment conditions — and time to scale. He also explores why we should look beyond tailpipe emissions to consider the full value chain, and the potential role of renewable fuels alongside electrification. And why the transition will only succeed if it works for consumers and businesses while keeping investment, innovation and value creation in Europe.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Fix airport queues by Christmas, migration commissioner tells Brussels Airport
“Member states had enough time to prepare themselves” for the EU’s Entry/Exit System, says Magnus Brunner. “It has to work.”
By Zoya Sheftalovich · Oct 11, 2026, 05:00 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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